

2c. Core Content of A Level in Art and Design

The following core content outlines the scope, context, approaches, skills and knowledge and understanding which underpin all the endorsed Art and Design

specialisms within the suite of qualifications. This needs to be used in conjunction with the content provided for each specialism.

Scope and Context	• Learners must engage in integrated critical, practical and theoretical study in Art and Design. • Learners must demonstrate an ability to work within relevant frameworks and use a broad range of media. They must develop independence in relation to exploring their own ideas and lines of enquiry, refining intentions and producing personal outcomes. • Understanding context is a significant element in the process of building knowledge of the subject. It provides the relevant platform to help explore and understand ideas, feelings and meanings. • Learners should demonstrate an understanding of the context through critical evaluation in relation to research, written analysis and practical work. Contextual referencing should be evidenced through evaluation of historical and contemporary practitioners, creative industries, societies and cultures, popular culture, historical and current events. • Learners' critical and contextual understanding will be evidenced throughout all processes and outcomes. The form of critical and contextual understanding may be directed by the approach to media used in the specialism(s) taken but not exclusively so. • Learners must demonstrate, where applicable, an awareness of different roles, functions, audiences and consumers of art, craft and design. • The related study element must extend learners' understanding and knowledge of context. Learners are required to establish, through this written and illustrated element, the overarching principles of their specialist area. This may be established by exploring art theory, genre, subject matter, movement or historical framework. • Through the course of study, learners must understand the importance of the on-going development and refining process. The production of outcome(s) in the context of developing their skills and knowledge, as well as an awareness of the links between practical and written material, is necessary. • Learners are required to identify and acknowledge all sources consulted during their research which should be in the form of a bibliography of books, journals and websites.
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